NVIDIA

FROM FOUNDER-POWERED TO SYTEM-POWERED

Employee Motivation & Team Decision-Making

Organizational Analysis and Recommendations

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NVIDIA

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

NVIDIA is a well-structured company in terms of incentives&motivations, with very little room to improve. Its structural decision-making process is regarded as one of its strengths.

We recommend NVIDIA to

1. Introduce a more detailed evaluation framework on top of their existing performance-based evaluation.

2. Adjust how criticism is delivered: Keep criticism in small groups and focused on the proposal itself, not on the person.

3. Give researchers ownership of technical problems.

AGENDA

- Company Overview
- Incentives & Motivation
- Teams & Team Decision-Making
- Organizational Diagnosis
- Recommendations & Vision for NVIDIA

COMPANY OVERVIEW

COMPANY OVERVIEW

Company Background

Founded in 1993, in Santa Clara.
NVIDIA’s invention of GPU in 1999 sparked growth of:
-PC Gaming Market
-Redefined Computer Graphics
-Revolutionized Accelerated Computing
-Ignited the era of modern AI

Recent News

- Vera Rubin entered full production to power next-generation agentic AI factories.
- NVIDIA is expanding its Physical AI ecosystem across robotics, manufacturing, and autonomous systems.

Business

From gaming graphics to leading provider of AI computing infrastructure. Today, NVIDIA provides end-to-end AI infrastructure that powers large-scale AI computing environments.

Status

- 42,000+ employees in 38 countries
- Record full-year revenue of $215.9 billion in FY26
- 9,800+ granted and pending patent applications worldwide
- 1,300+ projects released under an open source license
- Over 7.5 million developers in the NVIDIA Developer Program
- 38,000 global startups in NVIDIA Inception

COMPANY OVERVIEW

JENSEN HUANG

Leadership Style

- Set high standards
- Enphasize intelletual honesty
- Drive speed and urgency
- Direct access to information
- Maintain a flat project-based structure



INCENTIVES & MOTIVATION

INCENTIVES &MOTIVATION

Incentives encourage particular behaviors, while **motivation** explains why employees invest effort in their work.

Three Sources of Motivation

Financial rewards: Pay and financial benefits

Social motivation: Recognition and belonging

Intrinsic motivation: Interest in the work itself



Financial Rewards



Social Motivation



Intrinsic Motivation

NVIDIA'S INCENTIVES &MOTIVATION

Financial Rewards

- RSUs usually vest over four years if employees stay with NVIDIA. (NVIDIA Corporation, 2026, p. 62)
- This gives employees a financial reason to stay and can help teams keep experienced staff.

Social Motivation

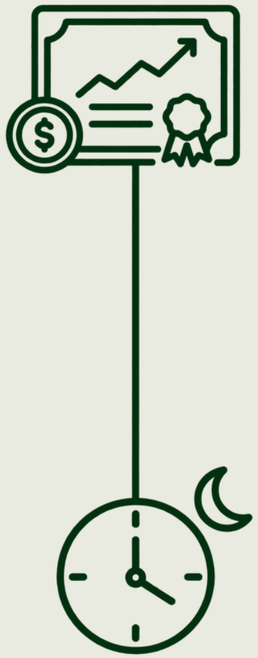
- NVIDIA emphasizes "One Team"; 95% of surveyed employees say they are proud to work there. (Great Place to Work, 2026; NVIDIA, n.d.)
- Feeling part of a team can make employees care more about the company's success.

Intrinsic Motivation

- Years of ray-tracing research helped NVIDIA develop RTX technology. (Salian, 2025)
- Solving challenging problems and seeing ideas become real products can make the work itself rewarding.

Together, these practices may help NVIDIA **retain talent** and **support innovation**. But to understand whether that motivation lasts, we also need to look at **employees' experience**.

BEYOND RETENTION



NVIDIA reported **3.7%** employee **turnover** in FY 2026. The figure shows employee continuity. ((NVIDIA Corporation, 2026, p. 11)

In **Bloomberg's** 2024 reporting, some current and former employees discribed **long hours and high stress** alongside substaintial stock gains. (Jetha & Gorelick, 2024)

> One former employee, who worked in technical support for enterprise clients, said he was expected to work 7 days a week, often until 1 a.m. or 2 a.m. He said many of his former colleagues, especially those on engineering teams, worked longer hours. He described the environment as a pressure cooker, noting several company meetings he characterized as yelling fights – but said the pay package made it hard to leave. He left in May and requested anonymity to speak frankly about the company.
>
> Another, who worked in marketing until 2022 and requested anonymity to protect her career, said she often attended 7 to 10 meetings per day, each with more than 30 people involved, often punctuated by bouts of fighting and shouting. But she said she put up with it for two years, because of the "golden handcuffs" – the opportunity for even more wealth.

QUESTION THIS RAISES

Are employees staying because they remain highly motivated, or partly because the financial cost of leaving is high?

TEAMS & TEAM DECISION-MAKING

NVIDIA'S TEAM STRUCTURE

CEO: Jensen Huang
Company-Wide Strategy and Leadership

Senior leaders - Specialized Functions
Engineering, product development, operations, sales, finance, and other functions

Hardware & System
GPU architecture, chips, servers, networking

Software & AI
CUDA, libraries, AI platforms, developer tools

Business & Sales
Enterprise customers, gaming, partnerships

Operations & Support
Supply chain, finance, HR, legal, Administration

Cross-Functional Project Teams
Hardware, software, systems, and business specialists collaborate across functions

Team Characteristic

Cross-Functional Collaboration

(Illustrative organizational structure based on NVIDIA FY2026 10-K and NVIDIA's official Culture & Values materials.)

NVIDIA'S TEAM STRUCTURE

SUPPORTS COGNITIVE DIVERSITY

Different data, experiences, and training
Different ways of interpreting a problem
Ideal teams bring distinct perspectives to the table

IN PRACTICE

- NVIDIA says there is "only one team".
- Teams form around projects based on the skills required (NVIDIA, 2025).
- This reduces reliance on fixed functional boundaries.
- Cross-functional expertise can be assembled around the problem.



Takeaway

NVIDIA builds teams around the problem, not the department, so different experts work on it together.

NVIDIA'S TEAM DECISION-MAKING

1. IDEA GENERATION

Talking Together Blocks Ideas

NVIDIA: "Top 5" emails replace status reports. Huang: I'm looking to detect the weak signals (Team, 2025).

STRENGTH

2. IDEA EVALUATION

Teams Rely on Common Knowledge

NVIDIA: 60 direct reports, no one-on-ones. Feedback to one leader is heard by all (Kahn, 2024).

STRENGTH

3. Deliberation

Needs Psychological Safety

Huang: "I'm always critical of everybody's work." (Fore, 2026). Public criticism may discourage speaking up.

LIMITATION

- Without psychological safety, decisions may follow Huang's will instead of true system decision-making

OVERALL STRUCUAL ANALYSIS

OVERALL ANALYSIS _STRENGTHS

Incentives & motivation system

- Financial rewards
- Social motivation
- Intrinsic motivation

Team structure

- Project based
- Cross-functional
- Diverse team members

Team desicion making

- Shared Information
- Direct Report
- Individual Idea Generation

Key Organizational Strengths

High empolyee retention
High commmitement
High willingness to innovate

Flexible expertise allocation

Reduce hierarchy
Cognitive diversity
High team coordination

UNDERLYING STRUCTURAL PROBLEM

NVIDIA's high-performance model creates three structural tensions :

1. EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

Employee Sustainability →

Coordination & Scalability →

Leadership & Decision-Making →

2. CRITICAL ASSESSMENT

High-performance culture

- Employee pressure
- Coordination & psychological strain

Rapid growth + complexity

- Coordination costs

Founder-centered leadership

- Decision bottlenecks / founder dependency

> What drives NVIDIA's exceptional performance today may become a constraint on sustainability and scalability tomorrow.

RECOMMENDATIONS &VISION

1: MORE DETAILED EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

As-Is

- Merit-based compensation/Reward System
- Proved to have “worked”
- Could underweight other factors that play a role in organizational maintenance

To Be

- Add another dimension to the evaluation framework:

  -Performance&Technical Impact

  -System-building Contribution

Expected Result: Stronger collaboration, knowledge-sharing, and scalable decision-making without sacrificing performance.

2: ADJUST HOW CRITICISM IS DELIVERED

As-Is

- Prominent culture of direct feedback
- Challenges the individual in that process

To Be

- “Challenge the proposal, not the proposer”
- Keep technical debate, reasoning, and lessons learned public, because NVIDIA benefits from shared information and collective learning

Expected Result: Higher psychological safety while preserving candid, high-quality debate.

3: HAVE RESEARCHERS DEVELOP OWNERSHIP OF THE PROBLEM

As-Is

- Founder-centered technical decision-making
- Jensen is personally involved in reviewing, challenging, and influencing many decisions.

To Be

- Build Cross-functional teams around the problem owner.
- CUDA provides an example of bringing top researchers and architects within the firm together. (NVIDIA, 2025).

Expected Result: Greater researcher autonomy and less dependence on senior leaders for technical decisions.

OVERALL VISION

Turn NVIDIA's founder-led strengths
into sustainable organizational capabilities for the AI era

Preserve what makes NVIDIA exceptional today, while building the organizational capabilities needed to adapt and scale in the fast changing AI era

1. SUSTAIN

Sustainable
Performance

High performance that is repeatable, not person-dependent.

2. MULTIPLY

Collective
Intelligence

More minds of expertise contributing to better decisions.

3. ADAPT

Adaptive
Advantage

AI Era - An organization that evolves as fast as the technology it leads.

A Stronger Foundation for Continuous Innovation

Thank you.

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APPENDIX REFERENCE LIST

Slide 5-6 _ Company Overview

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- NVIDIA News Room-Vera Rubin Ramps Into Full Production to Power Agentic AI Factories Worldwide: https://nvidianews.nvidia.com/news/vera-rubin-full-production-agentic-ai-factory
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Slide 12-14 _ Teams & Team Decesion-Making

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Slide 21 _ Recommendation 3

- NVIDIA Blog (2025, March) Innovation to Impact: How NVIDIA Research Fuels Transformative Work in AI, Graphics and Beyond: https://blogs.nvidia.com/blog/nvidia-research-ai-graphics